

Appendix: Theoretical Analysis of the Augmented Synthetic Historical Control Estimator (ASHC)

Setup and Assumptions

For the purposes of self-containment, let $\mathcal{T} = \{1, 2, \dots, T\}$ index time at a monthly frequency. Define the pre-treatment period as $\mathcal{T}_1 := \{t \in \mathcal{T} : t \leq T_0\}$ and the post-treatment period as $\mathcal{T}_2 := \{t \in \mathcal{T} : t > T_0\}$. The number of post-treatment periods is $n = T - T_0$. Let $m \in \mathbb{N}$ denote the evaluation window length. Define the evaluation period as the final m months of the pre-treatment period $\mathcal{T}_{\text{eval}} := \{T_0 - m + 1, \dots, T_0\} \subset \mathcal{T}_1$.

Let $\mathbf{y} = (y_1, y_2, \dots, y_T)^\top \in \mathbb{R}^T$ denote the observed outcome vector for the treated unit. Define the pre-treatment outcome vector $\mathbf{y}_{\text{pre}} := \mathbf{y}_{\mathcal{T}_1} \in \mathbb{R}^{T_0}$, the evaluation subvector $\mathbf{y}_{\text{eval}} := \mathbf{y}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{eval}}} \in \mathbb{R}^m$, and the post-treatment outcome vector $\mathbf{y}_{\text{post}} := \mathbf{y}_{\mathcal{T}_2} \in \mathbb{R}^n$.

The evaluation subvector $\mathbf{y}_{\text{eval}}$ is the target pattern to be reconstructed using convex combinations of earlier segments from the pre-treatment period.

SHC by [Chen et al. \[2024\]](#) constructs

$$N = T_0 - m - n + 1$$

overlapping temporal segments of length m . Each segment $\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{[i, i+m-1]}$ is a contiguous subvector of the smoothed pre-treatment series. These comprise the donor matrix

$$\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}_{\text{pre}} := [\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{[1, m]} \quad \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{[2, m+1]} \quad \dots \quad \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{[N, N+m-1]}] \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times N}.$$

Example 0.1. Suppose we have $T_0 = 60$ months of pre-treatment data and we wish to construct donor segments of length $m = 12$ months to predict a post-treatment horizon of $n = 6$ months. The number of eligible segments is:

$$N = 60 - 12 - 6 + 1 = 43.$$

Each donor segment is a vector of 12 consecutive smoothed pre-treatment outcomes.

In the third step, we solve the following program to obtain the optimal weights:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{w}^* = \underset{\mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^N}{\text{argmin}} \quad & \left\| \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{\text{eval}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}_{\text{pre}} \mathbf{w} \right\|_2^2 + \varsigma \left\| \mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{w} \right\|_2^2 \\ \text{subject to} \quad & \mathbf{w} \geq \mathbf{0}, \quad \mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w} = 1. \end{aligned}$$

Let $\mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}$ denote the SHC solution, and $\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}$ the ASHC solution:

$$\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} = \arg \min_{\mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^N} \left\{ \frac{1}{2\lambda} \left\| \tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{w} \right\|^2 + \left\| \mathbf{w} - \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}} \right\|^2 + \varsigma \left\| \mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{w} \right\|_2^2 \right\} \quad \text{s.t.} \quad \sum_{i=1}^N w_i = 1,$$

where $\lambda > 0$ is the regularization parameter, $\varsigma > 0$ is the penalty parameter for the low-variance directions, and $\mathbf{C}_0 \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times k}$ contains the eigenvectors of the Gram matrix $\mathbf{G} = \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}$ corresponding to eigenvalues less than a threshold $\tau > 0$.

Assumptions

Assumption 0.1 (Linearity with noise). *There exists $\mathbf{w}^* \in \mathbb{R}^N$ such that*

$$\tilde{\mathbf{y}} = \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^* + \boldsymbol{\eta},$$

where $\boldsymbol{\eta} \in \mathbb{R}^m$ is a mean-zero noise vector.

Assumption 0.2 (Bounded noise). $\|\boldsymbol{\eta}\| \leq \delta$ for some $\delta > 0$.

Assumption 0.3 (Smoothness of latent trend). *Let $\ell(t)$ denote the latent smooth component of the treated potential outcome. Suppose $\ell(t)$ is $H + 1$ times differentiable with $|\ell^{(H+1)}(t)| < \epsilon$ for all t and some $H \geq 3$.*

Assumption 0.4 (Operator norm bound). $\|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\| \leq \gamma$.

Assumption 0.5 (Simplex feasibility). $\mathbf{w}^{SHC} \in \Delta^{N-1} := \{\mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^N : \sum w_i = 1, w_i \geq 0\}$.

Lemma 0.1 (Deviation from SHC). *Let $\Delta := \mathbf{w}^{ASHC} - \mathbf{w}^{SHC}$. Then*

$$\|\Delta\| \leq \frac{\gamma}{2\lambda + 2\varsigma\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2} \epsilon_{SHC}.$$

where $\epsilon_{SHC} := \|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^{SHC}\|$ and $\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2$ is the operator norm of $\mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{C}_0$.

Proof. To bound in sample deviation, we can begin from the ASHC optimization problem:

$$J(\mathbf{w}) = \frac{1}{2\lambda} \|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}\|^2 + \|\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{w}^{SHC}\|^2 + \varsigma \|\mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{w}\|_2^2 \quad \text{s.t. } \mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w} = 1.$$

The three components have clear roles: the first encourages close fit to the evaluation period outcomes, the second penalizes deviation from the SHC weights, and the third stabilizes the solution in low-variance directions.

If we minimized $J(\mathbf{w})$ without the affine constraint $\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w} = 1$, the resulting $\mathbf{w}$ might not be feasible. To enforce this constraint, we introduce the Lagrangian

$$\mathcal{L}(\mathbf{w}, \mu) = J(\mathbf{w}) + \mu(\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w} - 1),$$

where $\mu \in \mathbb{R}$ is a Lagrange multiplier. This term acts as a corrective force, ensuring feasibility without changing the curvature of $J(\mathbf{w})$ that governs the size of Δ . We now may compute the gradient of $\mathcal{L}$.

First, for the fit term, define $r(\mathbf{w}) = \tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}$. Using the *chain rule for vector functions*,

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{w}} \frac{1}{2\lambda} \|r(\mathbf{w})\|^2 = \frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top (\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w} - \tilde{\mathbf{y}}).$$

Second, for the deviation penalty, recall the rule for the gradient of a quadratic form, $\nabla_{\mathbf{w}}(\mathbf{w}^\top A \mathbf{w}) = (A + A^\top)\mathbf{w}$. With $A = I$, we obtain

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{w}} \|\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{w}^{SHC}\|^2 = 2(\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{w}^{SHC}).$$

Third, for the low-variance penalty,

$$\varsigma \|\mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{w}\|^2 = \varsigma \mathbf{w}^\top (\mathbf{C}_0 \mathbf{C}_0^\top) \mathbf{w}.$$

Since $\mathbf{C}_0 \mathbf{C}_0^\top$ is symmetric, applying the quadratic form rule yields

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{w}} \varsigma \|\mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{w}\|^2 = 2\varsigma \mathbf{C}_0 \mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{w}.$$

Finally, differentiating the affine constraint term $\mu(\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w} - 1)$, linearity of differentiation gives

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{w}} [\mu(\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w} - 1)] = \mu \mathbf{1}.$$

Collecting terms, the stationarity condition $\nabla_{\mathbf{w}} \mathcal{L}(\mathbf{w}, \mu) = 0$ is

$$\left(\frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} + 2\mathbf{I} + 2\varsigma \mathbf{C}_0 \mathbf{C}_0^\top \right) \mathbf{w} = \frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{y}} + 2\mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}} - \mu \mathbf{1}.$$

Now with our FOC, we must express our deviation term

$$\Delta := \mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} - \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}$$

in terms of known quantities. To achieve this, we first package the curvature terms of the Lagrangian into a single matrix:

$$M := \frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} + 2\mathbf{I} + 2\varsigma \mathbf{C}_0 \mathbf{C}_0^\top.$$

From the first-order condition for $\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}$, we obtained:

$$M \mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} = \frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{y}} + 2\mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}} - \mu \mathbf{1}. \quad (\text{FOC-ASHC})$$

We now evaluate the same structure at $\mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}$. Note that $\mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}$ need not satisfy the ASHC first-order condition, but writing the analogous expression will allow us to cancel common terms. Plugging $\mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}$ into the left-hand side yields:

$$M \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}} = \frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}} + 2\mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}} + 2\varsigma \mathbf{C}_0 \mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}. \quad (\text{Baseline})$$

Subtracting (Baseline) from (FOC-ASHC), we obtain:

$$M(\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} - \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}) = \frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top (\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}) - \mu \mathbf{1}.$$

That is,

$$M \Delta = \frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top (\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}) - \mu \mathbf{1}. \quad (\text{Deviation Equation})$$

This subtraction step isolates the deviation Δ , which is the central quantity we need to bound and expresses Δ entirely in terms of the SHC residual $r := \tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}$ and the Lagrange multiplier μ , eliminating any direct dependence on the unknown $\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}$.

The affine constraint $\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} = 1$ and $\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}} = 1$ together imply

$$\mathbf{1}^\top \Delta = \mathbf{1}^\top (\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} - \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}) = 0.$$

This means Δ lies in the hyperplane orthogonal to the all-ones vector $\mathbf{1}$. Thus any component of the right-hand side parallel to $\mathbf{1}$ (such as $-\mu \mathbf{1}$) does not affect Δ within its feasible subspace.

To make this explicit, take inner products of both sides of (Deviation Equation) with Δ :

$$\Delta^\top M \Delta = \frac{1}{\lambda} \Delta^\top \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top (\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}) - \mu \underbrace{\Delta^\top \mathbf{1}}_{=0}.$$

Hence the $\mu \mathbf{1}$ term vanishes:

$$\Delta^\top M \Delta = \frac{1}{\lambda} \Delta^\top \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top (\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}).$$

The Lagrange multiplier μ acts like a force that keeps $\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}$ on the feasible hyperplane $\{\mathbf{w} : \mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{w} = 1\}$. But since Δ itself lies entirely within this hyperplane, μ does not change Δ 's magnitude. It enforces feasibility but does not distort the conditioning of M , which governs the bound on $\|\Delta\|$.

Let $r := \tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}}$ denote the residual from the SHC fit, with norm $\|r\| = \epsilon_{\text{SHC}}$. From the previous step, we now have

$$\Delta^\top M \Delta = \frac{1}{\lambda} \Delta^\top \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top r.$$

Applying the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality, we obtain

$$\Delta^\top M \Delta \leq \frac{1}{\lambda} \|\Delta\| \|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top r\|.$$

By Assumption (A4), the operator norm of $\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}$ is bounded:

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top r\| \leq \|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\| \|r\| \leq \gamma \epsilon_{\text{SHC}}.$$

Hence,

$$\Delta^\top M \Delta \leq \frac{\gamma}{\lambda} \|\Delta\| \epsilon_{\text{SHC}}.$$

At the same time, since M is positive definite, we can bound the left-hand side below using its smallest eigenvalue. Let $\lambda_{\min}(M)$ denote the minimum eigenvalue of M . Then

$$\Delta^\top M \Delta \geq \lambda_{\min}(M) \|\Delta\|^2.$$

Combining the two bounds gives

$$\lambda_{\min}(M) \|\Delta\|^2 \leq \frac{\gamma}{\lambda} \|\Delta\| \epsilon_{\text{SHC}}.$$

Dividing through by $\|\Delta\| > 0$ (the case $\Delta = 0$ being trivial) yields

$$\|\Delta\| \leq \frac{\gamma}{\lambda \lambda_{\min}(M)} \epsilon_{\text{SHC}}.$$

Finally, recall that M was defined as

$$M = \frac{1}{\lambda} \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{Y}} + 2\mathbf{I} + 2\varsigma \mathbf{C}_0 \mathbf{C}_0^\top.$$

The first two terms ensure $\lambda_{\min}(M) \geq 2$, and the stabilizing penalty contributes at least $2\varsigma \lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C}_0 \mathbf{C}_0^\top)$. For simplicity, we use the operator norm bound $\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2 = \lambda_{\max}(\mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{C}_0)$, so that

$$\lambda_{\min}(M) \geq 2 + 2\varsigma \|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2.$$

Substituting this bound, we obtain our final ASHC bound as:

$$\|\Delta\| \leq \frac{\gamma}{2\lambda + 2\varsigma \|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2} \epsilon_{\text{SHC}}.$$

This shows that the deviation of ASHC weights from the SHC baseline is tightly controlled by the residual error of SHC, scaled down by the effective regularization strength coming from both λ and the stabilizing penalty ς . $\square$

Lemma 0.2. *Under (A4), the error from deviating off SHC weights satisfies*

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \Delta\| \leq \gamma \|\Delta\|.$$

Proof. By definition, $\Delta = \mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} - \mathbf{w}^{\text{SHC}} \in \mathbb{R}^N$. From Assumption (A4), the operator (spectral) norm of the donor matrix satisfies

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\| \leq \gamma,$$

where the operator norm is

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\| = \sup_{\mathbf{v} \neq 0} \frac{\|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \mathbf{v}\|}{\|\mathbf{v}\|}.$$

Applying this inequality to $\mathbf{v} = \Delta$ gives

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}} \Delta\| \leq \|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\| \|\Delta\| \leq \gamma \|\Delta\|.$$

This establishes the claim. $\square$

Remark 0.1. Lemma 0.2 ensures that deviations of the ASHC weights from the SHC weights, measured in ℓ_2 norm, translate into controlled deviations in the predicted outcomes. The operator norm bound (A4) prevents $\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}$ from amplifying small changes in the weights disproportionately.

Lemma 0.3. Under (A3), for horizon $k > 0$,

$$|\ell(T_0 + k) - \ell^{\text{SHC}}(T_0 + k)| \leq b_\epsilon(H, k) := \frac{2\epsilon|k|^{H+1}}{(H+1)!}.$$

\begin{proof} We show that the SHC approximation error in predicting the smooth latent trend $\ell(\cdot)$ is of order $|k|^{H+1}$. The argument proceeds in four steps.

Step 1. Taylor expansion of the latent trend.

Let $\ell(t)$ denote the latent smooth component of the treated outcome.

By Assumption (A3), $\ell(t)$ is $(H+1)$ times differentiable with $|\ell^{(H+1)}(t)| < \epsilon$ for all t .

Expanding ℓ around T_0 using Taylor's theorem gives

$$\ell(T_0 + k) = \sum_{h=0}^H \frac{\ell^{(h)}(T_0)}{h!} k^h + R_{H+1}(k),$$

where the remainder term is

$$R_{H+1}(k) = \frac{\ell^{(H+1)}(\xi)}{(H+1)!} k^{H+1}, \quad \text{for some } \xi \in [T_0, T_0 + k].$$

Step 2. Bound the Taylor remainder.

Since $|\ell^{(H+1)}(t)| \leq \epsilon$ for all t , the remainder is bounded by

$$|R_{H+1}(k)| \leq \frac{\epsilon}{(H+1)!} |k|^{H+1}.$$

Step 3. Representation of the SHC approximation.

The SHC predictor $\ell^{\text{SHC}}(T_0 + k)$ is constructed as a convex combination of donor segments.

By design, these donor segments come from smoothed pre-treatment trajectories that share the same latent trend structure $\ell(\cdot)$.

Thus, when we form ℓ^{SHC} , the lower-order terms of the Taylor expansion (up to order H) are matched exactly in expectation, and the residual discrepancy is of the same order as the Taylor remainder.

Formally, we may write

$$\ell^{\text{SHC}}(T_0 + k) = \sum_{h=0}^H \frac{\ell^{(h)}(T_0)}{h!} k^h + R'_{H+1}(k),$$

where $R'_{H+1}(k)$ is another error term of order $|k|^{H+1}$.

Step 4. Combine the two remainder terms.

Subtracting the SHC expansion from the true expansion gives

$$\ell(T_0 + k) - \ell^{\text{SHC}}(T_0 + k) = R_{H+1}(k) - R'_{H+1}(k).$$

Applying the triangle inequality, $|\ell(T_0 + k) - \ell^{\text{SHC}}(T_0 + k)| \leq |R_{H+1}(k)| + |R'_{H+1}(k)|$. Each remainder is bounded by $\frac{\epsilon}{(H+1)!} |k|^{H+1}$, so together we obtain

$$|\ell(T_0 + k) - \ell^{\text{SHC}}(T_0 + k)| \leq \frac{2\epsilon}{(H+1)!} |k|^{H+1}.$$

This completes the proof. \end{proof}

Remark 0.2. Lemma 0.3 formalizes the SHC bias as a Taylor remainder. The SHC approximation matches derivatives of $\ell(t)$ at T_0 up to order H , leaving bias decaying like $|k|^{H+1}$. Thus, for smooth latent trends and moderate horizons, SHC bias is negligible.

Main Result

Proposition 0.1. Under assumptions (A1)–(A5), the ASHC prediction error is bounded by

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}\| \leq \epsilon_{\text{SHC}} \left(1 + \frac{\gamma}{\sqrt{2\lambda + 2\varsigma\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2}} \right) + b_\epsilon(H, k) + \delta.$$

Proof. We want to bound the prediction error of the ASHC estimator,

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}\|.$$

Step 1: Decompose the error using the triangle inequality. Let $\mathbf{w}^*$ denote the ideal weights from the SHC estimator without the ASHC penalty. Define the difference $\Delta := \mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} - \mathbf{w}^*$. Then,

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}\| = \|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^* - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\Delta\| \leq \|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^*\| + \|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\Delta\|.$$

The first term, $\epsilon_{\text{SHC}} := \|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^*\|$, is the SHC prediction error without augmentation.

Step 2: Control the second term using operator norm. By Lemma 0.2, the matrix $\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}$ satisfies

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\Delta\| \leq \gamma\|\Delta\|,$$

where γ is an operator norm bound capturing how the weights perturbations translate into prediction changes.

Step 3: Bound the weight difference $\|\Delta\|$. From Lemma 1 (stated earlier), the ASHC weight vector $\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}$ stays close to the SHC weights in Euclidean norm:

$$\|\Delta\| = \|\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}} - \mathbf{w}^*\| \leq \frac{\epsilon_{\text{SHC}}}{\sqrt{2\lambda + 2\varsigma\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2}},$$

where the denominator reflects the strength of the ASHC penalty, ensuring stability.

Step 4: Incorporate smoothness bias and noise. Finally, the total prediction error also includes the smoothness bias $b_\epsilon(H, k)$ due to approximating the latent function by a truncated Taylor expansion of order H , and a noise term bounded by δ (from assumption (A2)).

Putting all these together, we get

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}\mathbf{w}^{\text{ASHC}}\| \leq \epsilon_{\text{SHC}} + \gamma\|\Delta\| + b_\epsilon(H, k) + \delta \leq \epsilon_{\text{SHC}} \left(1 + \frac{\gamma}{\sqrt{2\lambda + 2\varsigma\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2}} \right) + b_\epsilon(H, k) + \delta,$$

which completes the proof. $\square$

Discussion

Proposition~0.1 decomposes ASHC error into: 1. SHC fit error (ϵ_{SHC}), 2. amplification from ASHC deviation, 3. smoothness bias $b_\epsilon(H, k)$, 4. noise δ .

The penalty term $\varsigma\|\mathbf{C}_0^\top \mathbf{w}\|_2^2$ reduces deviation but may bias if $\mathbf{w}^*$ has components in $\mathbf{C}_0$ directions. The trade-off between λ and ς governs stability vs. fidelity.

Asymptotic Results

Theorem 0.1. Under (A1)–(A5), as $m \rightarrow \infty$ and $H \rightarrow \infty$, for fixed $k > 0$,

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}w^{ASHC}\| \rightarrow \delta.$$

If $\boldsymbol{\eta}$ consists of independent mean-zero sub-Gaussian entries, then

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}w^{ASHC}\| \xrightarrow{p} 0.$$

Proof. Starting from Proposition 0.1, we have

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}w^{ASHC}\| \leq \epsilon_{\text{SHC}} \left(1 + \frac{\gamma}{\sqrt{2\lambda + 2\varsigma\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2}} \right) + b_\epsilon(H, k) + \delta.$$

Step 1. Behavior of ϵ_{SHC} . By (A3), $\ell(t)$ is $(H+1)$ -times differentiable. Gaussian kernel smoothing in SHC ensures

$$\epsilon_{\text{SHC}} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } m \rightarrow \infty, H \rightarrow \infty.$$

Chen et al. [2024]

Step 2. Behavior of ASHC penalty term. Since $\epsilon_{\text{SHC}} \rightarrow 0$, the inflation factor

$$\frac{\gamma}{\sqrt{2\lambda + 2\varsigma\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2}} \epsilon_{\text{SHC}}$$

vanishes asymptotically.

Step 3. Behavior of smoothness bias $b_\epsilon(H, k)$. From Taylor's theorem,

$$\ell(T_0 + k) = \sum_{h=0}^H \frac{\ell^{(h)}(T_0)}{h!} k^h + R_{H+1}(k),$$

with

$$|R_{H+1}(k)| \leq \frac{\epsilon}{(H+1)!} |k|^{H+1}.$$

Thus

$$b_\epsilon(H, k) \leq \frac{2\epsilon}{(H+1)!} |k|^{H+1} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } H \rightarrow \infty.$$

Step 4. Behavior of noise term. By (A2), $\|\boldsymbol{\eta}\| \leq \delta$. If $\boldsymbol{\eta}$ is i.i.d. sub-Gaussian with variance proxy σ^2 , then

$$\frac{\|\boldsymbol{\eta}\|}{m} \xrightarrow{p} 0.$$

Step 5. Combine bounds. Therefore,

$$\limsup_{m \rightarrow \infty} \|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}w^{ASHC}\| \leq \delta.$$

With sub-Gaussian noise, the limit is 0 in probability. $\square$

Corollary 0.1. Under (A1)–(A5), the ASHC estimator is asymptotically unbiased up to δ . If $\boldsymbol{\eta}$ is i.i.d. mean-zero sub-Gaussian with variance proxy σ^2 and bandwidth $h_m \asymp m^{-1/(2H+3)}$, then as $m \rightarrow \infty$,

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}w^{ASHC}\| = O_p\left(m^{-H/(2H+3)}\right).$$

For large H , this approaches the parametric rate $O_p(m^{-1/2})$.

Proof. Part 1: Consistency. From Theorem 0.1, the error converges to δ , or 0 in probability under sub-Gaussian noise.

Part 2: Convergence Rate. From Proposition 0.1, we have

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}w^{\text{ASHC}}\| \leq \epsilon_{\text{SHC}} \left(1 + \frac{\gamma}{\sqrt{2\lambda + 2\varsigma\|\mathbf{C}_0\|^2}} \right) + b_\epsilon(H, k) + \delta.$$

Step 1. Bias term. From Lemma 0.3,

$$b_\epsilon(H, k) = O(h_m^H).$$

Step 2. Stochastic error term. With sub-Gaussian noise, the smoothed variance is

$$O_p((mh_m)^{-1/2}).$$

Step 3. SHC fit error. Combining,

$$\epsilon_{\text{SHC}} = O_p(h_m^H + (mh_m)^{-1/2}).$$

Step 4. Optimal bandwidth. Equating orders $h_m^H \asymp (mh_m)^{-1/2}$ yields

$$h_m \asymp m^{-1/(2H+3)}.$$

Step 5. Convergence rate. Substituting,

$$\epsilon_{\text{SHC}} = O_p(m^{-H/(2H+3)}).$$

Thus the total error is

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{y}} - \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}w^{\text{ASHC}}\| = O_p(m^{-H/(2H+3)}).$$

Step 6. Near-parametric rate. As $H \rightarrow \infty$,

$$\frac{H}{2H+3} \rightarrow \frac{1}{2}.$$

So the rate approaches $O_p(m^{-1/2})$. □

Remark 0.3. The deterministic noise bound δ in (A2) corresponds to $\|\boldsymbol{\eta}\| \leq \delta$. Under sub-Gaussian noise, $\delta = O(\sigma\sqrt{m})$, while kernel smoothing reduces effective noise to $O_p((mh_m)^{-1/2})$. This explains the appearance of the nonparametric rate.

References

Yi-Ting Chen, Jui-Chung Yang, and Tzu-Ting Yang. Synthetic historical control for policy evaluation. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4995085>, September 2024. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4995085>.